

Week 11 — Lab Handout (Student)

Fix, Clean Up & Ship

Time: ~90 min in-class **Work as:** Your team (5 members) **AI use this week:** ✓ On — log prompts. Review AI fixes especially carefully near a release. **What you leave with:** A cleaner codebase and your app running at a live, public URL.

Why this lab matters

Today your app leaves your laptop. You'll clear the serious bugs from Week 10, pay down a little of the worst technical debt, and deploy to a real host — completing the request-response loop you started in Week 3. By the end, anyone with the link can use what you built.

Task 1 — Squash P0/P1 bugs (25 min)

Work the triaged list from Week 10, worst first.

- ☐ Fix P0 (broken core / data loss) bugs first, then P1.
- ☐ One bug (or small related set) per branch; reproduce → fix → add a test that catches it.
- ☐ Reviewed PR + green suite before merge.

Task 2 — Pay down debt (10 min)

- ☐ Pick one or two meaningful debt items (a duplicated block, a fat controller, a missing test on a critical path).
- ☐ Refactor with the test suite as your safety net; keep it green.
- ☐ Don't start new features or "while I'm here" rewrites.

Task 3 — Set up environments & config (15 min)

- ☐ Move anything that differs by environment into **environment variables** (DB credentials, base URL, keys).
- ☐ Confirm **no secrets are committed** to the repo; add an example env file documenting the keys.
- ☐ `APP_DEBUG` (or equivalent) is **off** for production.

Task 4 — Deploy to a live host (25 min)

- ☐ Provision a host (a free tier is fine).
- ☐ Set the production env vars/secrets on the host.
- ☐ Deploy your code.
- ☐ Run database migrations to build the production schema.

Task 5 — Smoke-test the live app (10 min)

At the public URL, not on your machine:

- ☐ Happy path works: create, view, edit, delete.
- ☐ A failure path works: submit bad data → the 422 error still shows.
- ☐ Record the live URL and deploy notes in `/docs/deployment.md`.

End-of-Lab Checklist

- ☐ P0/P1 bugs fixed via reviewed PRs; suite green
- ☐ One or two debt items paid down
- ☐ Config in env vars; **no secrets in the repo**; debug off in production
- ☐ App deployed; migrations run; live URL recorded
- ☐ Live smoke test passed (happy + one failure path)
- ☐ Prompt logs current in `/docs/ai-notes/week-11.md`

Looking ahead to Week 12

The finish line: a team **retrospective**, a professional **presentation with a live demo** of your deployed app, and each member's

unassisted oral defense of their own code — closing **Deliverable 4 (QA, Deployment & Final Presentation, 30%)**.